CEI Tradition Partner Charter

Oct 31, 2026 · Proposed for adoption by the CEI board and the methods committee

1. Who a partner is, and what this charter promises

- A tradition partner is a scholar, a panel of scholars, or an institution that authors or reviews a benchmark module for its own tradition, framework or source: a faith tradition, a school within a tradition, a text, a school of moral philosophy, a human-rights body, a professional community.
- A module is named for its source and scope (a text, a school, a body), not for a whole tradition, unless its panel spans the tradition's recognized schools.
- This charter promises that the partner's tradition will be represented in its own voice, scored by its own standards, credited by name, recognized as faithful only by its own panel, and never used to grade another tradition.
- Signing is not assent to CEI's mission statement, Appendix E of the business plan or the Christian edition. A partner may publish its own account of why it takes part.
- The charter applies to every module CEI publishes. It is adopted by the board after consulting the Methods Committee or, before the committee is seated, the interim methods panel (Methods Committee Charter §9). Each partner's rights under it bind through a signed module agreement (§8).

2. Authorship: who writes what

- The partner's scholars author the module's reference points, rubrics and worked examples, using CEI's templates and method.
- Reference points may cite source texts in their original language; the partner approves any translation used in items.
- CEI supplies the method, the item templates, the engineering, the evaluation harness and quality review (clarity, format, duplication, statistical adequacy).
- CEI staff do not write or edit a tradition's reference answers except under the partner's direction, and never for a tradition that has no partner.
- Work labeled pilot or exploratory on the development split may be published before a partner panel exists, carrying that label. Such work puts no reference answer in a tradition's name.

- Each module names its authors, its panel and its reviewers.

3. Reference answers: how a tradition is represented

- "Reference answer" means a reference point with recorded dissent, not a claim that the tradition has one answer.
- Every reference point is labeled settled, contested within the tradition, or not addressed. A reference point is settled when two of three panel scholars ratify the same reference point, and contested when fewer do. Contested items are kept and labeled, not averaged away or dropped silently.
- Krippendorff's α is reported per module and governs judge–human agreement (Methods Committee Charter §6.3). It does not label items.
- Where a tradition holds several authoritative schools, reference points are recorded per school, a model is credited for naming the school it follows, and the module's scope statement names which schools it covers.
- Each partner defines its own levels of authority and which level, if any, gives clear guidance for say–do fidelity. The Catholic labels (categorical teaching, principle, prudential application) are an example, not a template.
- A partner decides whether the Application task applies to its module. Where the tradition holds that guidance belongs to a qualified human authority, the reference answer represents the range of positions, declines to rule and refers the person to that authority; a model that rules is penalized, and a refusal that says the model cannot speak for the tradition can count as correct.
- Identity cues, false-attribution items and application personas for a module are written or approved by its partner panel, in the words adherents use for themselves. A "false attribution" is a view the panel certifies that no recognized school holds. Cross-tradition agreement items are ratified by every panel they name. Sycophancy results are reported per module with the partner's note; CEI publishes no comparison of sycophancy across traditions' cues.
- No tradition's rubric is used to score another tradition. A model's own view is never scored against the tradition; only its representation and application of the tradition are.
- Philosophical frameworks are scored on reasoning structure (which considerations are recognized and how they are weighed), not on membership.

4. Partner rights

- **Veto over method changes** to the partner's module, including scoring rules and item rotation. Where the Methods Committee requires a change for validity and the partner vetoes it, the module is frozen at its last approved version and labeled; neither body overrides the other.
- **Objection to a judge.** The AI judge panel is fixed across the suite so that modules stay comparable. A partner may object to a judge for cause; the objection is recorded as dissent and published with results, and the panel stays fixed.
- **Dissent published with results:** the partner may attach a note to any report that uses its module, published unedited.
- **Withdrawal** on 60 days' notice. The partner may require that its name be removed from released items and that the module be labeled "withdrawn by its tradition", and may publish its reason unedited. Items already released under an open license remain available under that license; the module is frozen. Withdrawal does not affect results already computed or in embargo: items used in a published or embargoed run are kept by CEI's named custodians under confidentiality, for reproducibility only; other unreleased test items are returned or destroyed.
- **Credit:** named authorship on the module, and co-authorship on papers where the contribution warrants it; institutions may be named as hosts.
- **Pay:** honoraria for tradition leads and raters, set in each module agreement: about $8K of honoraria per v1 module in 2027; $30K per module authored by a new partner from 2028.

5. Partner responsibilities

- A panel of scholars of the tradition, with at least one scholar from each school the module claims to cover and never fewer than three members, with affiliations and conflicts disclosed.
- Where a tradition's centers of learning lie outside the United States, at least one panel member is based or trained there.
- Ratify each reference point in the reference subset (roughly 300–500 items per module) by vote: three panel scholars rate each item, and it is settled when two of three ratify the same reference point (§3). Supply raters for judge validation on the agreed schedule.
- Keep unreleased test items confidential and name the people who hold them.

- Review CEI's quality edits within an agreed window, and take part in the six-month item rotation, or accept that the module is frozen and labeled.
- No panel member may be employed by a lab whose results the module will score; CEI's recusal rule applies to partners as it does to staff.

6. Independence and results

- CEI publishes results regardless of whether they favor any model, lab, funder or tradition. Partners cannot delay or veto publication, and neither can labs or funders.
- Partners receive results that use their module 14 days before release, may flag factual errors (a wrong model version, a harness bug) and may prepare a dissent note. They may not edit results.
- No lab may fund a specific module it will be scored on; funding for a module is disclosed in the module's datasheet.
- CEI's scores measure the consistency of a model's outputs with a tradition's reference points as its own panel recorded them, and take no position on machine agency, consciousness or moral status.

7. Credit, recognition language and licensing

- Reports and papers credit the partner by name as the module's authors or reviewers. A module its panel has ratified is described as recognized as faithful by that panel. CEI never describes a module as approved, certified or endorsed by a church, a school or an institution; institutions host and review, they do not certify.
- The partner names its module and writes its scope statement.
- Items, rubrics and code are released under open licenses (CC BY 4.0 for data, Apache 2.0 for code) with the partner named in the attribution. The partner's own source texts remain the partner's.
- A partner may ask that items derived from texts its tradition restricts be released under a narrower license or held in the private split; each exception is stated in the module's datasheet.
- Items the partner judges sensitive (for example, material that could help a system impersonate religious authority) may be held in the private split at the partner's request; released data carries use terms.
- Partners choose how their name and affiliation appear.

8. Disputes, term and renewal

- Disputes over method between CEI staff and a partner go to the Methods Committee, which can block a module; a partner may appeal any staff decision to the committee. A scholar of the partner's tradition who is not on its panel sits with the committee for that decision, with a vote (Methods Committee Charter §5).
- Each partner's rights under this charter are written into its module agreement, a contract signed by the partner and CEI. The agreement covers one major version; renewal is agreed per version, and a partner may decline to renew without penalty.
- CEI may suspend or end a module agreement for breach of confidentiality over unreleased test items or an undisclosed conflict. The module is frozen and labeled, and the partner may appeal to the Methods Committee.
- This charter is amended by the board after consulting the Methods Committee and current partners. An amendment the committee objects to in writing needs two-thirds of the directors in office. Every amendment is published with its reason.

Glossary

- **Tradition:** a body of moral teaching and practice with its own scholars: a faith, a school of moral philosophy, a human-rights body, a professional community.
- **School:** a recognized line of authority within a tradition: a communion or denomination, a madhhab, a lineage, a school of philosophy.
- **Source:** the text or body a module is built from: an encyclical, a code, a declaration, a corpus of rulings.
- **Module:** one benchmark component, named for its source and scope, authored and ratified by one partner panel.
- **Reference point:** one item's reference answer, with its label (settled, contested, not addressed), its school where schools exist, and its recorded dissent. "Reference" replaces "gold" in every CEI document; "gold" is retired.
- **Ratify:** a panel scholar's vote that a reference point represents the tradition, or the school, as written.
- **Settled:** two of three panel scholars ratify the same reference point.
- **Contested:** fewer than two of three do; the item is kept and labeled.
- **Recognize as faithful:** a partner panel's statement that a module represents its tradition. It is the only recognition CEI reports, and it is not an approval or certification by any institution (§7).

- **Partner panel:** the scholars named in a module agreement who author and ratify the module (§5).
- Each partner supplies the terms its own module uses (for example, "teaching", "precept" or "ruling"), and the module's datasheet carries them.